YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Marlo Quince

MASTER CHANDLER OF CANDLEWICK HALL

"Twenty years at the wax vats. You know how every candle in this house was made."

Come as: A long black cloak or dark bathrobe and a paper crown of candle flames cut from yellow card. Dot gold face paint across your cheeks.

Mask: a plain black eye mask, or two eye holes cut in a cereal box and tied with ribbon.



CHARACTER NO. 10

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Darcy Wickliffe

VESPER'S YOUNGER COUSIN AND HEIR

"Everyone calls you the heir. Nobody ever asks whether you want the job."

Come as: "The Golden Sun": yellow or gold clothes and a sunburst of paper rays around your face. Dot gold face paint freckles across your nose.

Mask: a gold paper half mask, or yellow card with two eye holes.



CHARACTER NO. 11

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Perry Lanthorn

LANTERN-MAKER WHO LIGHTS THE LANTERN GALLERY

"You light a hundred lanterns every Halloween. Tonight one of them lit itself."

Come as: A long coat or raincoat, a woolly scarf and a lantern to carry (a flashlight in a jar works). Pin a paper moth to your shoulder.

Mask: a moth-wing mask cut from brown paper or a grocery bag.



CHARACTER NO. 12

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Briar Fallow

COSTUME MAKER OF CANDLEWICK HOLLOW

"You stitched half the costumes in this ballroom. You know exactly who is wearing what."

Come as: An apron, a tape measure around your neck and a ribbon full of safety pins. A sponge on an elastic makes a pincushion bracelet.

Mask: a lace half mask, or a paper doily with two eye holes.



CHARACTER NO. 13

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Jory Greaves

PUMPKIN FARMER AND THREE-TIME CARVING CHAMPION

"Three carving trophies, one fox mask, and an alibi made of pumpkins."

Come as: An orange sweater or hoodie with a black cloak or blanket over your shoulders. Carry a toy pumpkin or a real small one.

Mask: a fox mask: orange card or felt with two pointed ears.



CHARACTER NO. 14

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Hadley Cresswell

EDITOR OF THE HOLLOW GAZETTE

"Every story in the Hollow crosses your desk. Tonight's was meant to be an exclusive."

Come as: A trench coat or long cardigan, a press card on a lanyard and a pencil behind your ear. Carry a small notebook.

Mask: a black half mask with PRESS written across the top in white.



CHARACTER NO. 15

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Auden Pryor

TOWN HISTORIAN AND KEEPER OF THE LANTERN GHOST LEGEND

"You know every legend in the Hollow. Tonight you met a new one."

Come as: A tweed jacket or cardigan, a scarf and an old book under your arm. Add a pair of glasses without lenses.

Mask: a brown paper owl mask with big round eyes.



CHARACTER NO. 16 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ TIME

PLACE RSVP

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Bexley Applegate

OWNER OF THE APPLEGATE CIDER PRESS

"You pour every cup of cider at the ball. You remember every cup."

Come as: A flannel shirt or plaid scarf and an apron. Tuck a ladle or a wooden spoon in your pocket.

Mask: a red paper apple mask with a green leaf at the top.



CHARACTER NO. 17 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ TIME

PLACE RSVP

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Corin Thimble

FIDDLER AND LEADER OF THE BALL'S BAND

"From the musicians' balcony you see the whole ballroom. Almost."

Come as: A waistcoat or vest, a bow tie made of ribbon and a toy violin (or a ruler for a bow).

Mask: a black-and-white piano-key mask drawn on card.



CHARACTER NO. 18 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ TIME

PLACE RSVP

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Larkin Hearthstone

BAKER OF THE CANDLEWICK PUMPKIN PIES

"Twenty-four pumpkin pies, one oven, and not a single minute to spare."

Come as: A white or striped apron, a sprinkle of flour on your sleeves and a rolling pin.

Mask: a pumpkin-pie mask: a paper plate painted orange with a crimped edge.



CHARACTER NO. 19 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ TIME

PLACE RSVP

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Teagan Bramwell

GROUNDSKEEPER OF CANDLEWICK HALL

"You hold a ring of forty keys. Tonight one door bothered you."

Come as: A barn coat or padded vest, work gloves and a big ring of keys (any keys will do).

Mask: a green leaf mask cut from card, like a hedge.



CHARACTER NO. 20 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Ainsley Duskwood

FORTUNE-BOOTH PERFORMER (STAGE ACT ONLY)

"You read fortunes for fun. Tonight nobody laughed."

Come as: A black cloak or shawl dotted with paper stars, lots of bangles and a scarf tied around your head.

Mask: a silver star mask cut from foil-covered card.



CHARACTER NO. 21 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Merritt Oxley

TOWN CLERK CARRYING VESPER'S PAPERS

"You carry the papers. You read the papers. You can't say a word about the papers."

Come as: A blazer or neat cardigan, a folder of papers and a fountain pen (any pen) clipped to your pocket.

Mask: a paper mask covered in tiny printed words, cut from an old newspaper.

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.



CHARACTER NO. 22 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder

Wynn Pennywhistle

PHOTOGRAPHER OF THE COSTUME PARADE

"You photograph every costume. Nobody notices the photographer."

Come as: Dark clothes, a camera on a strap (a phone works) and a beret or cap worn backward.

Mask: a camera-lens mask: a circle of black card with a silver ring.

DATE · OCTOBER __ _____ TIME _____

PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.



CHARACTER NO. 23 · OPTIONAL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

Open Invitation

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* Murder



CANDLEWICK HALL

Candlewick Hall · Halloween night · Costumes and masks encouraged

YOUR CHARACTER (THE HOST FILLS THIS IN)

"Masks, candlelight, a lantern ghost nobody can explain, and one announcement that was never made."

Come as: anything autumn, spooky-cozy or masked. Your character booklet has an outfit idea made from things in your closet.

Bring: a mask, a pen and your best detective face.

DATE · OCTOBER __ TIME

PLACE RSVP

A cozy, spooky-not-scary whodunit for ages 12+. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

FOR EVERY GUEST

How the night works

1. **Arrive in costume** (and a mask), pick up your name tag and read page 2 of your booklet quietly.
2. **Three rounds.** Share what your booklet tells you, ask your two questions and try your task. Evidence cards appear each round; read them, never remove them.
3. **The Costume Parade** between Rounds 2 and 3: strut, pose and vote for the best costume.
4. **Accuse.** Everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why. Then the truth is read aloud.

Spooky-cozy, never scary: no gore, no drinking, nothing unsuitable for ages 12+. Innocent characters may dodge questions about their secrets; only one person may lie outright.

Text Invitation

COPY · PASTE · SEND

Copy this into an email or group chat and swap in your details. Then send each guest their character, or use the Invitation Maker (Invitation-Maker.html) and the phone invitations in the E-Invites folder.

GROUP MESSAGE

You're invited to **The Candlewick Costume Ball Murder**, a cozy Halloween murder mystery!

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper has promised an announcement "that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Some say the Lantern Ghost will drift past the gallery windows again. Something tells us the announcement will never be made...

When: October [day], [time]
Where: [address]
RSVP: [by date, to whom]

Come in costume and bring a mask: everyone gets a character with an outfit idea made from things in your closet. It's spooky-cozy, not scary, and nobody has to act. Your booklet tells you what to say.

PRIVATE MESSAGE TO EACH GUEST

Hi [name]! At the Candlewick Costume Ball you'll play **[character name], [role]** (booklet No. [number]). Your costume idea: **[costume line]**. I'll hand you your booklet at the door, or I'm attaching it now. Please read only page 1 before the party; pages 2–4 wait for the ball!

HOST TIP

Send invitations one to two weeks ahead, or a few days ahead if your party is this weekend. Costume lines are on the Cast List (file 03) too.